AI Tools Comparison & Setup Guide

This guide compares popular AI coding agents, IDEs, and AI model platforms that can be used for **software development, Playwright automation, API testing, and AI-powered test automation**.

Note: AI tool pricing, model availability, quotas, and features can change frequently. Verify the current pricing on the respective official websites before purchasing a subscription.

AI Tools Comparison

Tool / Platform	Type	Pricing	Recommendation / Notes
Claude Code	Coding Agent	Pro: **$17/month**	Powerful coding agent from Anthropic. Excellent for code generation, refactoring, debugging, and working with large codebases.
Codex	Coding Agent	Plus: **₹1,999/month**	OpenAI's coding agent. Useful for software development, code analysis, debugging, and automation tasks.
GitHub Copilot	Coding Agent / IDE Integration	Pro: **$10/user/month**	Excellent integration with GitHub and VS Code. Provides code completion, Chat, and Agent capabilities.
OpenCode ⭐	Coding Agent	Go: **$10/month**; first month: **$5**	**Recommended for flexibility and cost control.** Open-source coding agent that supports multiple AI model providers.
Command Code ⭐	Coding Agent	Go: **$1/month**	**Recommended for low-cost experimentation.** Useful for developers who want an inexpensive AI coding agent.
OpenRouter ⭐	AI Model / API Platform	Pay-as-you-go	**Not a coding agent.** Provides access to many AI models and can be connected to coding agents such as OpenCode, Claude Code, and other tools.
Google Antigravity	AI IDE	Free models available	Google's AI-powered development environment with access to AI-assisted coding capabilities.

GitHub Copilot vs OpenRouter

A common point of confusion is that **GitHub Copilot and OpenRouter are not the same type of service**.

GitHub Copilot

GitHub Copilot documentation

GitHub Copilot is a **coding assistant / coding agent** integrated into development environments such as VS Code.

A normal Copilot subscription provides access to Copilot's supported features and models without requiring you to separately manage model-provider API keys.

OpenRouter

OpenRouter documentation

OpenRouter is primarily an **AI model/API platform**. It provides access to models from multiple providers through a unified API.

It does **not** work like a traditional coding-agent subscription.

Instead:

OpenRouter = Pay for the AI model usage you consume.

Three Ways (Options) to Use AI Coding Tools

Option 1 — GitHub Copilot Only

Best for: Simplicity

Subscribe to GitHub Copilot and use it directly inside VS Code.

Typical setup:

VS Code

↓

GitHub Copilot

↓

Supported AI Models

Advantages

- Simple setup
- Excellent VS Code integration
- GitHub integration
- Code completion

- Chat
- Agent capabilities
- No need to manage separate model API keys for normal Copilot usage

Do you need OpenRouter?

No.

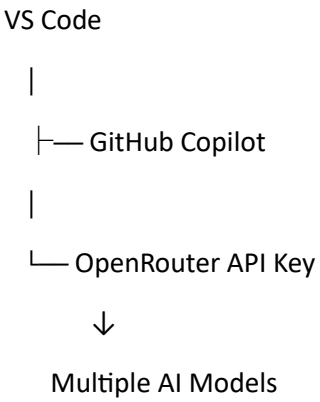
If your goal is simply to use GitHub Copilot's supported models and features, OpenRouter is not required.

Option 2 — GitHub Copilot + OpenRouter

Best for: Flexibility

You can combine GitHub Copilot with OpenRouter where supported through **BYOK (Bring Your Own Key)** functionality.

The basic concept is:



How it works

1. Maintain your GitHub Copilot subscription.
2. Create an OpenRouter account.
3. Add credits to OpenRouter.
4. Configure your OpenRouter API key where supported.
5. Use supported OpenRouter models through the relevant integration.

Important billing concept

Your **GitHub Copilot subscription and OpenRouter usage are separate billing mechanisms**.

Copilot usage follows GitHub's subscription/usage rules.

OpenRouter usage is charged against your OpenRouter balance according to the model and amount of usage.

Best suited for

- Developers who like the Copilot UI

- Developers who want access to additional models
- Developers experimenting with different AI providers
- Users who don't mind maintaining two services

Option 3 — OpenCode (Or) CommandCode with OpenRouter(Optional)

Best for: Maximum flexibility and budget optimization

If you don't want to pay for GitHub Copilot, you can use an open-source low priced agent such as OpenCode or CommandCode and connect it to an AI model provider such as OpenRouter(Optional).

OpenCode Documentation Command Code Documentation OpenRouterDocumentation

The architecture becomes:

VS Code / Terminal

↓

OpenCode /CommandCode

↓

OpenRouter (Optional)

↓

Multiple AI Models

Advantages

- No GitHub Copilot subscription required
- Open-source coding agent with less cost
- Multiple model providers
- Pay according to model usage
- Greater control over model selection
- Useful for experimenting with lower-cost models

Important

OpenRouter itself is **not the coding agent**.

Think of the tools this way:

Coding Agent → OpenCode
Model Provider → OpenRouter
IDE → VS Code
Automation Tool → Playwright
MCP Server → Playwright MCP

Command Code

Command Code Documentation

Command Code is a low-cost AI coding agent that can be used from the terminal.

Installation

```
npm install command-code@latest
```

Verify Installation

```
cmdc --version
```

Login

```
cmdc login
```

The command opens a browser for authentication.

Alternatively, you can create an API key and authenticate using the key.

API Key

Command Code Studio

Start Command Code

Navigate to your project directory:

cd /path/to/project

Then run:

```
cmdc
```

Add Playwright MCP to Command Code

```
commandcode mcp add playwright -- npx @playwright/mcp@latest
```

Verify MCP Servers

```
commandcode mcp list
```

You should see the Playwright MCP server in the configured server list.

OpenCode

OpenCode Documentation

OpenCode is an open-source coding agent designed to work with different AI model providers.

Install

```
npm install -g opencode-ai
```

Configure a Provider

Start OpenCode:

opencode

Use:

/connect

Select the appropriate provider and follow the authentication instructions.

After configuring the provider/API key, OpenCode can use the selected AI model.

Initialize OpenCode in a Project

Navigate to your project:

cd /path/to/project

Start OpenCode:

opencode

Then initialize the project:

/init

OpenCode analyzes the project and creates an:

AGENTS.md

Claude Code

Claude Code Documentation

Claude Code is Anthropic's coding agent for working with software projects directly from the terminal and supported IDE integrations.

VS Code Integration

Claude Code VS Code Documentation

The VS Code integration provides a graphical interface for working with Claude Code directly inside the IDE.

Add Playwright MCP to Claude Code

claude mcp add playwright npx @playwright/mcp@latest

After configuring the server, Claude Code can use Playwright MCP capabilities for browser automation tasks.

Other AI Agents

For configuring Playwright MCP with other compatible AI agents, refer to:

Microsoft Playwright MCP GitHub Repository

GitHub Copilot + VS Code

GitHub Copilot in VS Code

GitHub Copilot is deeply integrated with VS Code and provides AI-assisted coding features directly inside the IDE.

Add Playwright MCP to VS Code

```
code --add-mcp '{"name":"playwright","command":"npx","args":["@playwright/mcp@latest"]}'
```

This configures Playwright MCP as an MCP server that can be used by compatible AI features in VS Code.

Caveman — Token Saving Tool

Caveman can be used as a terminal utility intended to help reduce unnecessary context/token consumption when working with AI coding agents.

macOS / Linux / WSL / Git Bash

```
curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/JuliusBrussee/caveman/main/install.sh | bash
```

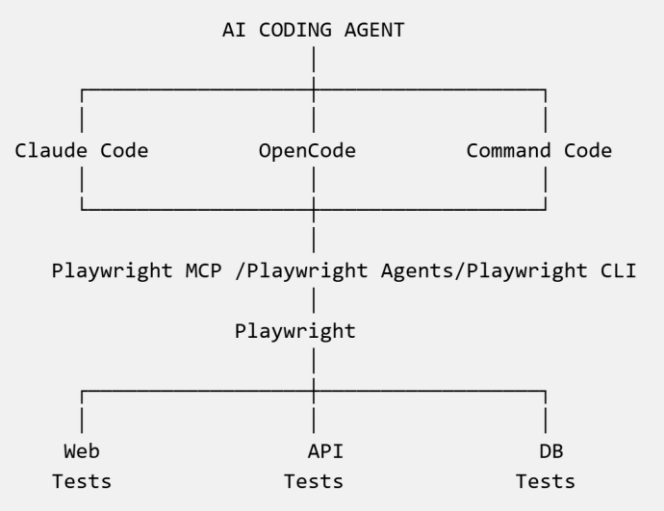
Windows

```
irm https://raw.githubusercontent.com/JuliusBrussee/caveman/main/install.ps1 | iex
```

Note: Review any installation script before executing it, particularly when installing third-party command-line tools.

Recommended AI Setup for Playwright Automation

For a **Playwright + TypeScript + AI-powered automation framework**, a practical setup is:



```
IDE (VS Code/Antigravity)
            ↓
Coding Agent (Claude Code / OpenCode / Copilot / Command Code)
            ↓
AI Model (GPT,DeepSeek,Opus,Gemini Flash/Pro etc..)
            ↓
Playwright MCP/Playwright CLI
            ↓
External Tool (Playwright)
            ↓
          Browser
```